Buddy Editor

VERSION 4.0.1

User manual

Installation and the Podcast, Silences, Zoom and Angles modules

Extension for Adobe Premiere Pro (Windows)
Package: **BuddyEditor-4.0.1.zxp** · Version 4.0.1 · November 2026

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What Buddy Editor is

Buddy Editor is an extension for Adobe Premiere Pro on Windows that automates repetitive editing tasks. It reads the audio straight from the original files, shows a preview of what it will do, and only touches the timeline when you click apply.

Modules

Each module lives in its own tab of the panel.

Module (tab)	What it does
Buddy Podcast Podcast tab	Cuts and switches the cameras of a podcast based on who is speaking.
Buddy Silences Silences tab · free	Removes the pauses from a talking-head video, on every track at once.
Buddy Zoom Zoom tab	Adds automatic zooms on cuts, speech and voice emphasis.
Buddy Angles Angles tab	Switches the camera angles of one speaker, only at the pauses in the speech.

Principles

- **Nothing changes until you click.** Analysis only reads the audio; the timeline changes only when you click apply.
- **There is always a backup.** Before editing, Buddy duplicates the sequence. See Backup copy.
- **Nothing is rendered.** Buddy reads the audio from the media files, so analysis is fast and runs on your computer.
- **The result stays editable.** Cuts, disabled clips and keyframes sit on the timeline as if you had made them by hand.

Requirements

- Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit). macOS is not supported yet.
- Adobe Premiere Pro 2022 (version 22) or newer.
- The free aescripts **ZXP Installer**, to install the plugin.
- Internet to activate the license and receive updates. Once activated, Buddy works for up to 7 days offline.
- Nothing else to install: the package already includes FFmpeg, a free program (LGPL license) that Buddy uses to read audio.

Installation

Buddy Editor ships as a single file, **BuddyEditor-4.0.1.zxp**, installed with the aescripts ZXP Installer.

Step by step

1. **Install the ZXP Installer.** Download it from the aescripts website and install it. You only do this once.
2. **Download Buddy Editor.** On the download page, get the **BuddyEditor-4.0.1.zxp** file.
3. **Close Premiere Pro.**
4. **Open the ZXP Installer and drag the .zxp file into it.** Wait for the installation complete message.
5. **Open Premiere** and go to `Window > Extensions > Buddy Editor`.

> **Did you download the right file?**
>
> On the GitHub download page, get **BuddyEditor-4.0.1.zxp**. "Source code (zip)" and "Source code (tar.gz)" are the source code and do not install the plugin.

What happens on first launch

- Buddy installs FFmpeg in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\BuddyEditor\bin` and creates its data folders in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\BuddyEditor`.
- The panel may show "Waiting for Premiere to respond..." while the project finishes opening. This can take up to a minute.
- Then the **Activate Buddy Editor** screen appears. See Activation and license. The Silences tab works without activation.

> **Panel missing from the menu?**
>
> Make sure Premiere was closed during installation and install again with the ZXP Installer. If it persists, restart the computer.

Activation and license

Buddy Silences is free and works without activation. The other modules need the free trial or a license.

Activating Buddy Editor

When the panel opens without a license, the **Activate Buddy Editor** screen offers two options:

- `Start 7-day free trial`: no card needed, all modules unlocked. One trial per computer.
- `License key`: paste the `BUDDY-XXXXX-XXXXX-XXXXX-XXXXX-XXXXX` key from your email and click `Activate`. Spaces and lowercase are accepted.

Computers

Each license covers **2 computers** (for example, a desktop and a laptop). To use it on another computer, free a slot in `Settings > License > Deactivate this computer` and activate on the new computer.

Offline use

Buddy checks the license online every time the panel opens. Without internet it keeps working for up to **7 days**. After that, the paid modules lock until the next check: connect and reopen the panel.

Locked tabs

A tab with a **yellow lock** is a module your license does not include. To unlock it, start the free trial or activate a key that includes that module.

License status

Status	What it means
Active	All good.
Not activated	Buddy has not been activated on this computer yet.
Expired	The subscription or trial has ended.
Needs online check	Buddy could not check the license for 7 days.
Other computer	The license was activated on another computer. Activate it here with your key.
Clock changed	The computer's date and time were changed. Fix the clock and reopen the panel.

The panel

The Buddy panel is under `Window > Extensions > Buddy Editor` and can be docked like any Premiere panel.

Parts of the panel

- **Top:** active sequence name, frame rate and duration. The circular arrows button **refreshes** the active sequence. The gear opens Settings.
- **Tabs:** Podcast, Silences, Zoom and Angles.
- **Banners:** appear under the tabs when an update is available, while Buddy waits for Premiere, or when something goes wrong (with the `Send diagnostics` button).
- **Footer:** Premiere version, whether an NVIDIA (CUDA) graphics card was detected, and the Buddy version.

> **When to click refresh**
>
> Click the refresh button at the top whenever you switch sequences, add or remove tracks, or change the In and Out marks.

Language

Buddy follows Premiere's language: Portuguese when Premiere is in Portuguese, English otherwise. To change it, open `Settings` and pick the `Language`. The change applies immediately.

Updating and uninstalling

Updating

When a new version is out, a banner appears at the top of the panel.

1. Click **Update**. Buddy downloads the new version and checks its signature.
2. If Windows asks for permission, click **Yes**.
3. Close and reopen Premiere. Your settings are kept.

You can also look for new versions in **Settings > Updates > Check for updates**. The list of versions is in Version history.

> **If the permission is declined**
>
> The `.zxp` file is saved to your Downloads folder. To install it: close Premiere, open the ZXP Installer and drag the file into it.

Uninstalling

1. If you will use the license on another computer, click **Deactivate this computer** in Settings > License.
2. Close Premiere.
3. Open the ZXP Installer and remove Buddy Editor.

The data folder `%LOCALAPPDATA%\BuddyEditor` (settings and FFmpeg) is kept. Delete it manually if you want.

Analyze, preview, apply

All four modules follow the same steps. Nothing changes on the timeline until the last click.

The workflow

1. **Configure.** Open the sequence in Premiere and the module's tab. Buddy lists only the tracks that have clips and fills in default values. The setup is saved automatically for each sequence, and the last one used carries over to new sequences.
2. **Analyze.** Click `Analyze audio` (in Zoom, `Analyze timeline`). Buddy reads the audio straight from the original files: it renders nothing and does not change the timeline. You can stop it with `Cancel`.
3. **Check the preview.** A bar shows the whole timeline, with counts and warnings. Changing a rule updates the preview instantly, without analyzing again.
4. **Apply.** Click the blue button. Buddy checks the sequence has not changed, creates the backup, edits and shows the result with the backup name.

If the sequence changed after the analysis (another active sequence, a different duration or new In and Out marks), Buddy asks you to analyze again.

Backup copy

Before touching the timeline, Buddy duplicates the sequence as `<name>_BuddyBackup_<date_time>`. The result message shows that name.

> **To go back**
>
> Open the `_BuddyBackup_` sequence in the Project panel. It is an exact copy from before the edit.

Recurring controls

- `Fine tuning (advanced)` reveals the manual controls. You rarely need it: Buddy calibrates itself on every analysis.
- **Exact values:** double-click a number, type and press Enter (Esc cancels). Comma or dot both work.
- `Generate another variation` (Zoom and Angles) draws a new version. The preview and the applied edit are always identical.
- **Range** (Silences and Zoom): `Entire sequence` or `Sequence In/Out`, using Premiere's I and O marks.

Clips Buddy skips

During analysis Buddy skips the clips below, and the preview reports how many:

- disabled clips;
- clips with speed other than 100%, or reversed;
- nested sequences and multicam;
- items without a media file (generated inside Premiere).

Buddy Podcast

Buddy Podcast edits podcasts recorded with several cameras and one microphone per person. It listens to the mics, works out who is speaking at each moment and puts that person's camera on air.

- **Whoever is loudest on their own mic wins.** A person's voice leaking into the other mics is always quieter, so it is ignored.
- **The sequence duration does not change.** Buddy cuts and turns camera pieces on or off, but never pulls the timeline (no ripple delete).

Preparing the sequence

- **One microphone per audio track** (A1, A2, A3…). If several mics share one multichannel file and each channel sits on its own track, Buddy splits the channels by itself, in the order Premiere shows them (Ch. 1, Ch. 2…).
- **One camera per video track** (V1, V2, V3…).
- **Everything in sync** before using Buddy.

1. Speakers

- Buddy creates a speaker for each audio track with clips. Type each person's name and check the `Mic track` (A1, A2…).
- The checkbox next to the name includes or ignores that mic. `Add speaker` creates one more.
- `Fine tuning (advanced)` shows each mic's **Silence gate**, the `Auto-calibrate` button and the channel choice. Leave the channel on `Automatic (same as Premiere)`.

2. Cameras

- For each video track, mark whose camera it is. One person: **Solo camera**. Several people: **Group shot**. Nobody: **Not used** (Buddy leaves that track alone).
- A person can have more than one camera (for example, a close-up and a medium shot). With Maximum shot on, Buddy alternates between them during long turns.
- The **Cameras linked** summary warns when a speaker has no camera.

> **Wide shot**
>
> Mark the wide camera for **all** speakers. It becomes a group shot: it goes on air when two people talk together and alternates with the speaker's camera during long turns.

3. Rules

The defaults work for most podcasts.

Option	What it does
Minimum shot Default: 2.0 s	Turns shorter than this do not switch cameras. Avoids choppy cuts on "uh-huh" and short laughs.
Maximum shot Default: 6.0 s · can be turned off	During long turns, switches to another camera marked for the same person (another angle or the wide shot) at each interval.

Option	What it does
Pause tolerance Default: 1.5 s	Pauses shorter than this keep the current speaker on air.
Edit mode Default: Cut and switch cameras	**Cut and switch cameras**: keeps only the speaker's camera on air. **Cut only (keep all visible)**: only cuts at speaker changes, so you choose the cameras yourself.
Camera layers Default: Stack	**Stack**: only the camera on air stays on; each camera stays on its own track. **Linear**: moves every piece that goes on air, in order, to a new video track on top.
Where to cut Default: Only tracks that change	**Only tracks that change**: each switch cuts only the camera leaving and the one entering. **All tracks**: each switch cuts every camera track.
Unlink audio and video before cutting Default: on (recommended)	Makes sure cutting a camera never cuts its audio too.
Also cut the mic audio Default: off	When on, the mic tracks are also cut at every switch.
Inactive cameras Default: Disable clips	**Disable clips**: pieces off air stay on the timeline, disabled (you can re-enable them). **Delete clips (lift)**: deletes those pieces and leaves a gap.
Inactive microphones Default: Keep audio intact	**Mute other mics while someone speaks**: while one person speaks alone, the other mics are cut and disabled, removing bleed and noise.
Speaker markers Default: off	Adds a sequence marker at every switch, with the person's name.
Empty tracks after editing Default: Keep all	Can delete the empty video and/or audio tracks of the sequence, including ones that were already empty.

Analyze and apply

1. Click `Analyze audio`. The preview shows the timeline colored by the camera on air, the number of cuts, each person's speaking time, cross-talk and silence.
2. Adjust the rules if you want. The preview updates instantly.
3. Click `Apply cuts to timeline`.

Preview warnings

Warning	What to do
Mics receiving the same audio	Use the `Split channels automatically` button in the preview.
Little speech detected	Check in 1. Speakers that each person is on the right track, or open Fine tuning and lower the silence gate.
No audio found on a mic	Check the mic track is right (A1, A2…).

Warning	What to do
Speaker without a camera	Mark a camera for them in 2. Cameras. Meanwhile, the previous camera stays on air.

Buddy Silences

Buddy Silences removes the pauses from a talking-head video. It finds the silences on one audio track and cuts **every unlocked track** at the same points, so everything stays in sync. It is free.

> **Use it first**
>
> Run Silences as the first step of the edit, before music, b-roll or lettering. See why in B-roll and lettering.

1. Audio

- `Analyzed track`: the voice track, A1 by default.
- `Silence level` (default −38 dB): anything below it counts as silence. Raise it if room noise is not detected; lower it if soft words are being cut.
- `Range`: Entire sequence or Sequence In/Out.
- Locked tracks stay out of the edit. If the analyzed track is locked, it goes out of sync with the rest.

2. Rules

Option	What it does
Shortest silence to remove Default: 300 ms	Shorter pauses stay in the video.
Keep after the speech Default: 100 ms	Room left at the end of a sentence, before the cut.
Keep before the speech Default: 100 ms	Room left before the next sentence starts, after the cut.
Remove short sounds between silences Default: on · up to 150 ms	An "uh", click or lip noise alone in the middle of a pause is removed with it.
What to do with the silences Default: Cut and ripple delete	**Cut and ripple delete**: removes them and closes the gaps; the video gets shorter. **Cut and delete**: removes them and leaves the gaps. **Cut only**: only cuts, deleting nothing, so you can review.
Audio fade at each cut Default: off · 66 ms	A short audio-only fade so cuts do not pop. The video stays a hard cut. The value is rounded to whole frames.

Analyze and apply

1. Click `Analyze audio`. On the preview bar, **blue stays and yellow is removed**.
2. Check the number of silences, the time removed, the duration now and the duration after.
3. Click `Apply cuts to timeline`.

B-roll and lettering

A track with a gap under a silence can keep the gap from closing on every track. When that happens Buddy stops the edit to keep everything in sync and shows how many silences were already removed. Go back with the backup

copy and run Silences before building the upper tracks.

> **Linked clips**
>
> If Premiere does not cut clips with linked audio and video, Buddy unlinks them by itself, tries again and says so in the result message.

Buddy Zoom

Buddy Zoom adds automatic zooms to keep talking-head videos moving. Zooms are **Scale** and **Position** keyframes on the Motion effect, so they stay editable. Nothing is cut or deleted, and the duration does not change.

1. Triggers

- `Target track (the top one)`: zooms apply to this track and every track below it. Keep lower thirds, graphics and b-roll on a track above so they stay still.
- `Ignore cuts on these tracks`: cuts on the checked tracks do not start zooms, but their clips still follow every zoom.
- `Zoom pace`: from Calm to Intense (default Medium). More intense = zooms that come more often, move faster and go a bit further.
- `Voice track` (A1 by default): used by the speech and emphasis triggers.

Trigger	Default	When it starts a zoom
Cut	Always on	At the cuts of the timeline.
Speech	On	When speech starts again after a pause.
Voice emphasis	Off	When the voice gets louder than usual (a punchline, an exclamation). Uses the maximum zoom.

`Fine tuning (advanced)` holds **Pause before the speech** (default 0.6 s), **Emphasis sensitivity** (default +6 dB) and the **Voice level**, auto-calibrated on every analysis.

2. Framing

- Click the frame preview to set the **anchor point**, the point that stays still while zooming. The dashed box shows what stays on screen at the maximum zoom.
- `Center` and `Face (upper third)` are shortcuts for the anchor point.
- **Minimum zoom** and **Maximum zoom** range from 101% to 200% (default 110% and 130%).

3. Style

Style	What it looks like · good for
Jump cut	Instant zoom, no animation. YouTube, commentary and high-energy edits.
Smooth	Eased zoom in and out. Interviews, lessons and storytelling.
Snap-in	Fast animated zoom in, instant zoom out. Podcasts, business and social videos.

Check one or more; Buddy mixes the checked styles. Cuts lean to Jump cut and voice emphasis uses Snap-in.

`Subtle handheld movement` (off) adds a small drift while zoomed in, like a handheld camera, without ever showing the edges of the image.

Analyze and apply

1. Click **Analyze timeline**. The preview shows each zoom colored by style, the time zoomed in and the triggers found.
2. Use **Generate another variation** if you want another version.
3. Click **Apply zooms to timeline**.

> **Clips that get no zoom**
>
> Clips that already had Scale or Position keyframes are left as they are. Clips without the Motion effect, with speed other than 100% or reversed are skipped too. Without FFmpeg, only the Cut trigger works and the frame preview stays neutral.

Buddy Angles

Buddy Angles is for videos of **one person** filmed with several cameras (wide, close-up, side…). It switches angles in random order, only at the pauses in the speech, so a word is never cut. The sequence duration does not change.

1. Angles

- `Voice track`: the track with the person's audio. Buddy finds the pauses on it.
- Check the video tracks that are angles of the same person (at least two) and name each one. Without a name they become "Angle 01", "Angle 02"…
- `Main camera`: by default all angles are equal. If you pick a main camera, it comes back on air after every other angle and stays on screen longer.
- `Fine tuning (advanced)` holds the channel, the **Silence gate** (auto-calibrated) and **Gate above the noise** (default 8 dB).

2. Rules

Option	What it does
Micro pause Default: 0.12 s	Shortest silence between words that can take a switch.
End of sentence Default: 0.40 s	Silences at least this long count as an end of sentence.
Prefer the end of a sentence Default: on	Uses an end of sentence first; a micro pause only when there is none.
Minimum shot Default: 3.0 s	No angle stays on air for less than this.
Maximum shot Default: 10.0 s	Switches at a pause near a random time in this range. Without a pause, it waits for the next one.

The edit options are the same as in Buddy Podcast, with the same defaults: Edit mode, Camera layers, Where to cut, Unlink audio and video, Also cut the voice audio, Inactive cameras and Empty tracks after editing.

Analyze and apply

1. Click `Analyze audio`. The preview shows each angle in its own color, the time of each, the ends of sentence and micro pauses found, and the average shot.
2. Use `Generate another variation` to draw a new order and new shot lengths, always at pauses.
3. Click `Apply cuts to timeline`.

> **Switching in the middle of speech?**
>
> Open `Fine tuning (advanced)` and lower the **Silence gate**. If no pauses are found, raise the gate or lower the micro pause.

Settings and diagnostics

The gear at the top of the panel opens Settings.

Sections

Section	What it is for
Language	Automatic (follows Premiere), Português or English.
Local binaries	Shows where FFmpeg is and lets you choose another `ffmpeg.exe` with **Browse**. Usually not needed.
Runtime	Premiere version, detected graphics card, data and logs folders, with the **Open in Explorer** button.
License	Status, plan, key, expiry, **Check now** and **Deactivate this computer**.
Updates	Installed version and **Check for updates**.
Diagnostics	Technical tests (use them only when support asks) and **Send diagnostics**.

Send diagnostics

If something goes wrong, send diagnostics to support:

1. Click **Send diagnostics** on the error banner or in Settings > Diagnostics.
2. Describe what happened. If you want, click **See what will be sent**.
3. Click **Send**. Buddy shows a code such as `BR-7F3K9Q`: give that code to support.

> **What is sent**
>
> Nothing is sent until you click. It sends the Buddy and Premiere versions, the end of your license key, an anonymous ID for this computer and the last lines of the log. Your Windows user name is removed from file paths.

Buddy folders

Folder	Contents
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\BuddyEditor\bin`	FFmpeg.
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\BuddyEditor\config`	License and each module's saved settings.
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\BuddyEditor\logs`	Diagnostics log (`buddy.log`).

Troubleshooting

Find the message or situation in the tables. If nothing helps, use Send diagnostics.

Installation and connection

Situation	What to do
The panel is missing from Window > Extensions	Install again with the ZXP Installer while Premiere is closed. If it persists, restart the computer.
"Waiting for Premiere to respond..."	Normal while the project opens. It can take up to a minute.
"Premiere did not respond to Buddy"	Wait for the project to finish opening and click refresh. If it persists, close the Adobe Stock panel (**Window > Adobe Stock**), restart Premiere and send diagnostics.
"Open a sequence in Premiere Pro"	Open the sequence on the timeline and click refresh at the top of the panel.

License

Situation	What to do
Tab with a lock	Your license does not include that module. Start the free trial or activate a key.
"Needs online check"	Buddy was offline for 7 days. Connect and reopen the panel.
"This license is already active on the maximum number of computers"	Deactivate it on another computer first, in Settings > License.
"Clock changed"	Fix the Windows date and time and reopen the panel.

Analysis and cuts

Situation	What to do
Little speech detected or "No audio found"	Check the mic or voice track is right (A1, A2...). For a multichannel file, keep the channel on Automatic.
Mics receiving the same audio	Use the **Split channels automatically** button in the Podcast preview.
Cuts or switches in the middle of speech	Open Fine tuning and lower the silence gate. In Silences, lower the Silence level.
"The sequence changed since the analysis"	Click Analyze again before applying.
"This Premiere version cannot unlink by script"	Select the clips, use **Clip > Unlink** (Ctrl+L) and apply again.
Some cuts could not be confirmed	Check the timeline at that point. If something is wrong, go back with the backup copy.

Situation	What to do
Error in Linear mode	If Premiere does not create the new track, nothing is cut. If it cannot move the pieces, the cuts were already made: go back with the backup copy.
Silences: "Premiere could not close the gap on every track"	An upper track has a gap under a silence. Go back with the backup copy and run Silences before adding b-roll and lettering.
Zoom: clips skipped	Clips that already had Scale or Position keyframes, have no Motion effect, or have speed other than 100% get no zoom.

Updating

Situation	What to do
Windows asked for permission and I declined	The `.zxp` file was saved to your Downloads folder. Close Premiere and install it with the ZXP Installer, or click Update again and accept.
"The download failed"	Check your internet and try again.

Version history

The full notes for each version are on the releases page.

Version	What changed
4.0.1	The Profanity and Captions tabs are hidden for now.
4.0.0	New Buddy Zoom module.
3.0.3	Silences: fixed the "Premiere did not accept the cuts" error that blocked every cut.
3.0.2	Silences: unlinks audio and video by itself when Premiere does not cut linked clips.
3.0.1	Angles: a name for each angle.
3.0.0	New Buddy Silences module.
2.0.2	Fixed "Premiere did not respond to Buddy" on some computers.
2.0.1	Podcast: "No audio/video track" warnings on an empty timeline.
2.0.0	New Buddy Angles module.
1.0.9	Send diagnostics button.
1.0.8	One-click update also works in protected folders.
1.0.7	Waits up to 90 s for Premiere and adds the diagnostics log.